

HOUSE RESOLUTION 187

By Todd

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Mickie Whitaker for her distinguished service to mental health advocacy.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body take great pleasure in recognizing those individuals who have devoted their lives to the service of others; and

WHEREAS, Mickie Whitaker is one such exemplary individual, whose decades of selfless service and unwavering dedication to mental health advocacy have made a lasting impact upon the citizens of Madison County and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Whitaker began her journey with the National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI) in the early 1990s, following her son's diagnosis with schizophrenia; rather than yielding to uncertainty or fear, she sought out knowledge, support, and community, transforming her personal experience into a lifelong mission of service; and

WHEREAS, through her involvement with NAMI Madison County in Jackson, Mickie Whitaker became a dedicated educator in the organization's Family Education Program, equipping families with essential tools and understanding to support loved ones living with mental illness; and

WHEREAS, she later expanded her service to become a trainer, empowering others to teach and to extend the reach of NAMI's programs throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, as one of the early grassroots leaders working to establish and strengthen NAMI Tennessee, Mrs. Whitaker helped lay the foundation for a more informed, compassionate, and supportive network of mental health advocacy across the State; and

WHEREAS, even while raising four children and supporting her family, Mickie Whitaker has remained steadfast in her service, continuing to advocate for mental health awareness,

encourage community engagement, and promote the vital mission of NAMI, particularly in areas where awareness remains limited; and

WHEREAS, it is wholly fitting that we specially recognize Mickie Whitaker for her outstanding service to mental health advocacy and enduring commitment to the well-being of others; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Mickie Whitaker for her exemplary service to mental health advocacy, extend to her our sincere appreciation for her many contributions to the people of Tennessee, and wish her every continued success and happiness in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.